

Ada Johnson

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Product Strategy & Operations leader with 20 years of experience at Airbnb, Google, Target, and Best Buy. A multiplier: I find the signal in customer, frontline, and operational data, connect it to the right people, and turn individual expertise into collective capability, through feedback loops and operating models that help organizations learn faster and scale responsibly.

CAREER ARC

Customer-Centric Operator → Product & Growth Strategist → Scalable Systems Builder → AI-Enabled Multiplier

CORE CAPABILITIES

Product Strategy & Operations Retail Merchandising & Buying Global Sourcing AI-Enabled Systems Voice of Customer Operating Models Go-to-Market Strategy Strategic Partnerships

EXPERIENCE

AIRBNB · 2026 – Present

Manager, Project Implementation | Fraud & Safety Delivery, Scaled Services

Led a team of 6 within Airbnb's newly formed Scaled Services organization, resolving ownership ambiguity across implementation, policy, and operations teams, and building how we measure whether an implementation actually succeeds, not just whether it ships on schedule.

AIRBNB · 2023 – 2026

Manager, Product Operations | Global Fraud & Safety Operations

Led Product Strategy & Operations for Airbnb's global Fraud & Safety ecosystem, building and scaling a Product Operations team of 4 that connects frontline insights, operational signals, and business outcomes across 70+ enforcement workflows spanning identity, safety, financial fraud, and content & account integrity.

- Designed and launched Queue Health Monitor (QHM), an operating system that transformed fragmented operational reporting into a unified view of performance, root causes, incidents, launches, and frontline insights across five Fraud & Safety domains
- Built Airbnb's first AI-enabled frontline feedback intelligence system, transforming 1,500+ operational signals into 46 problem clusters, including 9 critical issues, that surfaced platform risks, operational inefficiencies, and prioritized product opportunities
- Built AI-assisted workflows for business reviews and root-cause analysis, and created a closed-loop system linking Trust & Safety specialists directly to Product and Engineering, accelerating synthesis while keeping human validation and full visibility from signal to shipped solution
- Established Product Operations operating rhythms, ownership models, and executive reporting frameworks that improved alignment across Product, Engineering, Analytics, and Operations

GOOGLE · 2021 – 2023

Strategy & Product Operations Principal | Google Technology & Engineering

Led strategy and transformation initiatives for Google's global frontline technology support organization, redesigning operating models to improve scalability, efficiency, and workforce sustainability.

- Built the strategy and business case to transition 800+ frontline support roles from contractor to employee workforce across 7 global locations, aligning Engineering, Finance, HR, and Legal stakeholders
- Reduced operational risk and improved support continuity through a redesigned workforce model and clearer ownership structure
- Developed prioritization frameworks and executive decision mechanisms that accelerated alignment across complex stakeholder groups

GOOGLE · 2019 – 2021

Strategy & Product Operations Lead | Google One Partnerships

Led global partner strategy and operations for Google One, scaling a consumer subscription product through telecommunications, OEM, and retail partnerships.

- Expanded Google One distribution from 2 to 40+ global partners, supporting an addressable audience of 89M+ users and contributing to 95% subscription growth
- Built repeatable launch frameworks, partner playbooks, and operating rhythms that enabled global expansion across diverse markets
- Translated partner insights, performance data, and customer signals into recommendations influencing product roadmap and growth strategy

FOUNDATIONAL EXPERIENCE

GOOGLE · 2018 – 2019

Product Planning Lead | Google Store

Built Google's retail hardware strategy by identifying customer demand signals and creating new channels for product discovery.

- Developed assortment strategy and P&L frameworks supporting Google hardware growth
- Created 10+ business plans connecting customer insights, financial opportunity, and operational execution

GOOGLE · 2017 – 2018

General Manager | Google West Hollywood Pop-Up Store (short-term)

- Directed 40+ cross-functional staff to launch Google's first LA pop-up retail store, exceeding sales and conversion targets by 5%
- Provided learnings that informed Google's retail expansion strategy

GOOGLE · 2016 – 2018

Global Program Manager | Google Merchandise Store

Built and scaled Google's global merchandise program across 48 countries, connecting customer experience, brand strategy, and operational execution.

- Increased revenue 43% over two years while managing a \$14M global program
- Introduced Google hardware into the merchandise ecosystem, generating \$9M incremental revenue and 81K+ device sales
- Created a customer-driven retail model that informed Google's broader hardware strategy

TARGET CORPORATION · 2014 – 2015

Senior Buyer | Infant & Toddler Furniture

Transformed a declining \$75M category through customer insight, assortment strategy, and digital experience redesign.

- Reversed category performance from declining growth to +20% YoY improvement
- Increased engagement and conversion through customer-centered merchandising experiences

TARGET CORPORATION · 2012 – 2014

Senior Product Manager | Global Sourcing, Women's Apparel

Managed global sourcing strategy for \$90M in owned-brand products across international supplier networks.

- Delivered \$4M annual cost savings through supplier strategy and process improvements
- Built scalable sourcing frameworks supporting 1,800+ retail locations

BEST BUY CORPORATION · 2006 – 2012

Merchant & Category Strategy | Various Categories

Managed multi-million-dollar product portfolios, partnering with vendors and cross-functional teams to optimize assortment, drive growth, and improve customer experiences.

- Led publisher partnerships and go-to-market strategies across 500+ SKUs
- Co-developed a \$5M Batman Arkham City launch campaign generating \$10M first-week revenue and significant market share growth

LEADERSHIP

- Co-Founder & Lead Organizer, Black in Product Operations @ Google
- Former Alumni Board President & Guest Lecturer, UMN College of Design
- NCAA Division I Track & Field, University of Minnesota (Alumna)

EDUCATION

- MBA, Business Entrepreneurship, Bethel University, Saint Paul, Minnesota
- BS, Retail Merchandising & Business Management, University of Minnesota, Twin Cities